

Using articles to generalize

"The" is the most commonly used word in the English language. It can be used in many different situations, as can the indefinite article "a," and the zero article.

-  **New language** Generic "the"
- Aa Vocabulary** Exploration and invention
-  **New skill** Using advanced articles

69.1 KEY LANGUAGE GENERIC "THE"

You can use "the" with a single countable noun to talk about a class of things in general. Inventions, musical instruments, and species of animal are often referred to in this way.



The telescope changed the way we see the night sky.

Referring to an invention,
not an individual telescope.



The violin is often the key instrument in an orchestra.

Referring to a type of musical instrument,
not an individual instrument.



The cheetah can run faster than any other land animal.

Referring to a species of animal,
not an individual animal.



69.2 CROSS OUT THE INCORRECT WORDS IN EACH SENTENCE



Look over there! There's **a** / ~~**an**~~ / ~~**the**~~ lion and her cub.

1



Apparently, **a** / **an** / **the** French horn is the most difficult instrument to play.

2



Alexander Graham Bell is often credited with inventing **a** / **an** / **the** telephone.

3



My sister has **a** / **an** / **the** saxophone that she plays in her school orchestra.

4



A / **An** / **The** blue whale is the largest animal that has ever lived on Earth.

